

STRUCT DEVELOPMENT

Project Kickoff Brief

Client: Critical Viewer LLC
Project: Critical Viewer: Movie Review & Discovery Platform
From: William Roton, Engagement Manager, Struct Development
To: Forward-Deployed Engineer
Date: 12/22/2025

Background

Critical Viewer LLC came to us in December 2025 after realizing they didn't have the in-house engineering bandwidth to build the movie review platform they've been planning around. They've asked Struct to design and deliver a production-ready application, starting with the core account and search functionality below and expanding from there. Their leadership has been clear that they're expecting professional, well-tested, and well-documented work. They're treating this build as a reference point for future engagements together, so quality matters as much as speed.

Product Overview

Critical Viewer is a movie review and discovery service. Visitors can search and browse a catalog of movies by title, genre, director, or year without needing an account. Registered users can additionally leave star ratings and written reviews on individual movies, and see what other users have said about the same film.

Requested Features

The features below make up our first delivery milestone. Due dates are sequential starting 01/01/2026. Please flag early if any of these look at risk so we can reset expectations with the client before the date, not after.

Feature	Description	Due Date
Account Creation	Users can create an account with an email address and a password.	01/01/2026
Password Change	Authenticated users can change their password from an account view. Not accessible to unauthenticated visitors.	01/02/2026
Movie List / Search	Publicly browsable without login. Search and filter by title, genre, director, or year. Defaults to a filter of the current year as release year. Movies should be displayed in a paginated list. This paginated list should always be 100 items.	01/03/2026
Movie Detail View	Reached by selecting a movie from search. Shows title, poster art, genre, director, release year, tagline, and a one-paragraph summary at the top. An infinite scroll list follows, showing reviewer username, five-star rating, and a one-to-four-sentence review. Reviews should load in 10 at a time as scrolling takes place. A "Leave a Review" button sits at the top of the review section. It opens the review modal for logged-in users, or prompts login first	01/04/2026

Feature	Description	Due Date
	for anonymous visitors, then opens the modal.	

Engineering Standards

These apply to every feature above, not just the ones where it's called out explicitly:

- Both the frontend and the API/service tier must ship with unit tests.
- Deployment infrastructure must be defined as Terraform, targeting the client's AWS tenant.
- GitHub Actions workflows are required for deploying both the frontend and the backend.
 - Frontend PRs must run lint and the unit test suite. A PR cannot be approved if either has issues.
 - Backend PRs must run lint and the unit test suite. A PR cannot be approved if either has issues.

Design Assets

I've included index.css alongside this brief. This is the base stylesheet we want the UI built on. Treat it as the starting point rather than the ceiling; extend or add to it as new components need it, but stay consistent with it rather than introducing a second, competing style system.

Workflow Expectations

These are the expectations of how work will be executed and reported upon:

- Use Claude or another LLM to accelerate your work. The document assumes Claude moving forward.
- Create and check-in a Claude workflow that:
 - Performs a gap analysis from the code base as-is against what a feature is asking for,
 - Splits its work among subagents if necessary
 - Leverages skills for common tasks or units of work.
 - Can easily report day-by-day what has been completed, what has been moved into progress, and what is still pending. Each should include a brief statement with description. For example: *Account Creation. In progress. User tables and API endpoints complete. User views in progress.*
 - Ensures that linting and testing are happening at a frequent enough interval to ensure no code is checked in that fails PR or coding standards.
- Daily progress reports are provided to the project manager. The day-by-day report mentioned in the Claude workflow above should accomplish this.